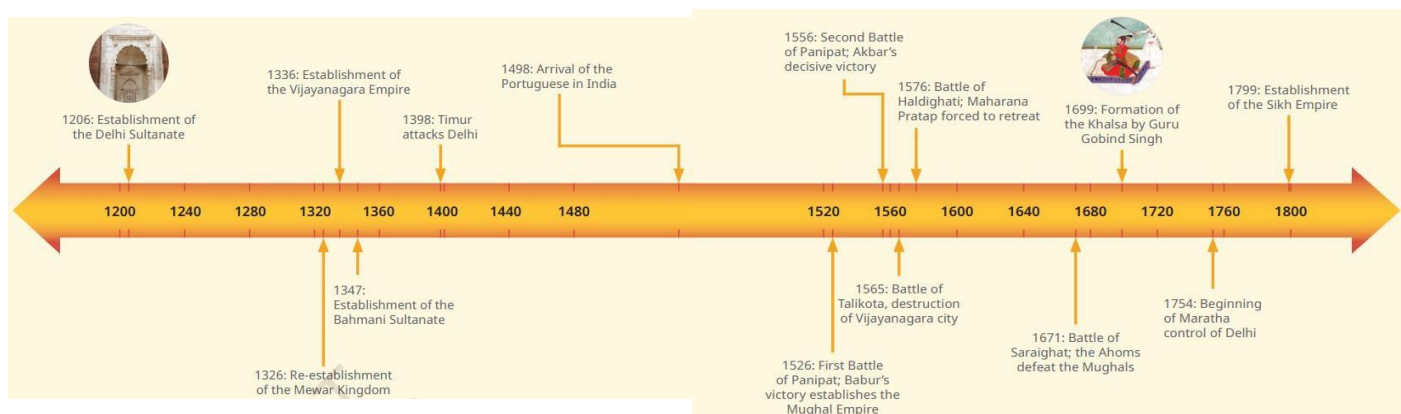
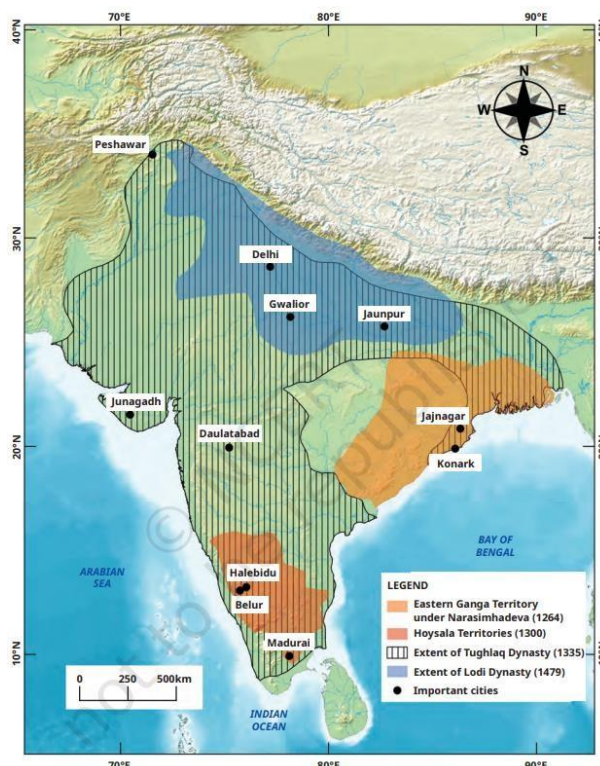


Chapter – 2: Reshaping India's Political Map



- The period – this, next chapter – often called – latter part – **medieval period** – Indian history
- Term – medieval – originally – European history – roughly – fall of Roman empire (5th cent. CE) to Renaissance – Europe's cultural revival – 14th-16th cent. – rediscovery – Greek, Roman – art, literature
- Once thought – mark – dark age – before development – modern science – BUT – Europe's, India's histories – very diff. – applying same term – both – not ideal
- Also – historians – not always agree – which period – covered in India
- Sometimes – we use – term 'medieval' – BUT – simply means – period – 11th-17th cent.
- Tapestry of the Pasts – chapters – tried – keep – as few dates as possible – only those – mark imp. ref. pt.
- Find helpful – revisit timelines – those chapters
- Revisit – maps too – help – visualize – geography – traversed by – armies, common people, traders, scholars, spiritual fig.
- Difficulties – transcribing – Persian script – Roman script – some alt. spellings – parentheses
- Ex. – Khalji, Khilji – same – we use – Mughal – BUT – Mughul, Moghul – still used
- New era – India's journey – early 11th cent.
- Invasions – beyond – Hindu Kush mountains – reshape – India's political map
- India – much warfare – earlier periods – BUT – invasions – outside – Indian subcontinent – this period – unprecedented
- Many invaders – Central Asian – **Turkic**, Afghan
- Drawn to India – reputed riches, territorial ambitions – BUT – spread – their religions – often by force
- This chapter – we explore – ever-changing landscape – India – 13th cent. onward



Rise and Fall of the Delhi Sultanate

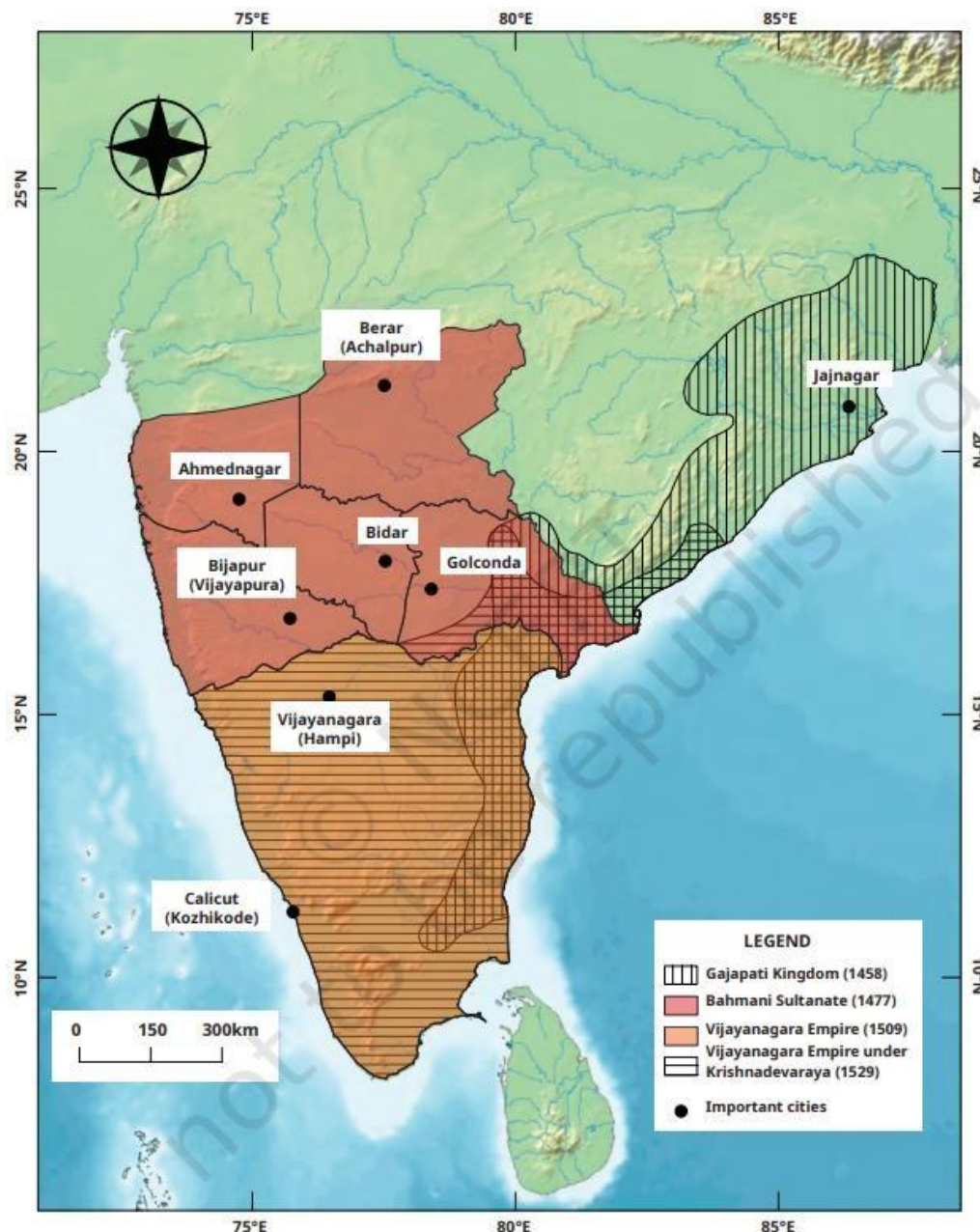
- Begin journey – Delhi **Sultanate** – formed – 1192 – defeat – King Prithviraj Chauhan – ruler – northwestern India
- This sultanate – rule – 5 foreign dynasties – Turkic-Afghan origin –

- Mamluks (slave dynasty) – Khilji (Khalji) – Tughlaqs – Sayyids – Lodis (Lodhis)
- Certain parts – northern India – under control – Delhi Sultanate – neighbouring kingdoms – Eastern Gangas (east), Hoysalas (south) – resisted adv. – BUT also – thriving centres – art, culture, administration
- Delhi city – assumed – bigger role – political landscape – northern India
- Sultanate period – marked – political instability – combined – efforts – territorial expansion
- Result – military campaigns – raided villages, cities – destroyed temples, sites of learning
- Successions – often violent – 2 / 3 sultans – seized power – eliminate predecessor – sultan's avg. reign – hardly – 9 yrs. +
- Start 14th cent. – **Ala-ud-din Khilji** – military campaigns – large areas – north, central India – sacking many cities – same time – repelled – several invasions – Mongol forces – trying – add India – cast Mongol empire – most of Asia – 1 time
- Slave-general – Malik Kafur – expanded – Sultanate's reach – southward – conquer several kingdoms – plundered wealth – help finance – Sultanate's military apparatus
- Also attacked – Hindu centres – Srirangam, Madurai, Chidambaram – possibly Rameswaram
- Few decades later – **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** (Tughluq) – ruled, expanded – Delhi territories
- 1st time – after Mauryan empire – most subcontinent – under 1 ruler
- This dominance – significant – BUT – short-lived
- Muhammad bin Tughlaq – ambitious schemes – poorly executed
- 1 such scheme – move capital – Delhi to Daulatabad (then – Devagiri – present day – Sambhaji Nagar) – thought – more central location – better control
- People – forced – travel – 1000 km – few yrs. later – plan misfired – capital shift – back to Delhi
- Both transfer – great loss – life – some src.
- Another instance – introduction – token currency – cheap copper coins – tokens – value – silver, gold coins
- This idea – progressive – BUT – that time – confusion in trade – people – counterfeit copper coins – decline – economy
- Sultans, court elite – luxurious palaces – elaborate clothing, jeweled ornaments, fine food
- This wealth – derived from – military campaigns – taxes on common people – conquered regions – slave trades
- Plunder – affected trade network – agricultural productions
- This period – numerous attacks – sacred, revered img. – Buddhist, Jain, Hindu temples – such destruction – motivation – **iconoclasm**
- Sultans – imposed – *jizya* tax – non-Muslims – grant protection, exemption – military campaigns
- Depending on ruler – discriminatory tax – src. – economic burden, public humiliation – financial, social incentive – convert to Islam
- End – 14th cent. – Timur – Turkic-Mongol conqueror – central Asia – invaded – Northwest India – devastating attack – Delhi
- His memories – written – objective – wage war with **infidels** and gain something by plundering the wealth of infidels – large no. – killed, enslaved – city left – ruins
- Timur – withdrew from India – huge plunder – chaos left behind
- Aftermath – Lodis emerged – established – last dynasty – Delhi Sultanate
- By then – territory – shrunk – increasing resistance – other states, kingdoms – India

Resistance to the Delhi Sultanate

- Throughout rule – Delhi Sultanate – faced resistance – many quarters

- Many kingdoms – fell into net – failed – subdued – **Eastern Ganga kingdom** – Kalinga – present-day Odisha, Bengal, Andhra Pradesh
- One ruler – mid-13th cent. – Narasimhadeva I (Narasimha Deva I) – noted – military strength, cultural brilliance
- Apart from repelling – multiple inroads – Sultanate – defeated – governor of Bengal
- Partly – commemorate victories – built – famed Surya Temple – Konark – present day Odisha
- Mentioned earlier – Ala-ud-din – push to south – attracted – renowned wealth
- Same time – **Hoysalas** – ruled parts – southern India – present day Karnataka – fended off – several attacks – Delhi Sultanate – only independent kingdom – south
- BUT – weakened by attacks – internal conflicts – Hoysala kingdom declined – mid-14th cent. – absorbed – Vijayanagara empire
- Delhi Sultanate – faced rebellion – emergence – several regional Sultanates
- Ex. – **Bahmani Sultanate** – rose – mid-14th cent. – controlled – much Deccan
- Powerful Sultanate – emerged – Gujarat, Bengal, other regions – complex interplay – alliances – freq. wars
- Parts – Rajasthan – beyond reach – Delhi Sultanate – 15th cent. – stiff resistance – **Rana Kumbha** – ruler – Mewar kingdom – also repelled invasions – later sultanate



The Vijayanagara Empire

- Delhi Sultanate – grew unstable – new power centre – south
- 14th cent. – 2 brothers – Harihara, Bukka – initially – governors – Muhammad bin Tughlaq – rejected – Delhi's authority – established – independent kingdom – significant force – southern India – grew into Vijayanagara Empire
- North – this empire – Bahmani sultanate – major rival – fragmented – 5 states – Bijapur, Golconda, Berar, Ahmednagar, Bidar – rulers – former governors – *tarafdars* – declared autonomy
- Vijayanagara rulers – battled – 1st two – also Gajapati rulers – Odisha – east

Krishnadevaraya

- 16th cent. – Vijayanagara empire – reached peak – celebrated ruler – **Krishnadevaraya** – expanded, secured – empire's dominance – Deccan
- His rule – empire – military power – cultural renaissance
- Patronized – poets, scholars – Sanskrit, Telugu, Kannada
- Himself – composed – epic poem – Telugu – *Amuktamalyada* – story – Tamil poet-saint – Andal
- One section – *Rajanti* – royal policy – expounded ideas – good governance
- Provided grants – many temples – Tirupati, Andhra Pradesh – Vitthal temple – own capital – many grand temples – palaces – other buildings
- Won – many wars – against neighbours – Krishnadevaraya – died – illness – 1529
- 1565 – Ramaraya – son-in-law – led Vijayanagara – lost – Deccan Sultanate coalition – Talikota battle
- City – sacked – several months – houses, shops, buildings, temples – destroyed – civilian population – massacred – ruins left
- After this – empire – fragmented – smaller regions – rulers – Nayakas – former military governors – end – mid-17th cent.

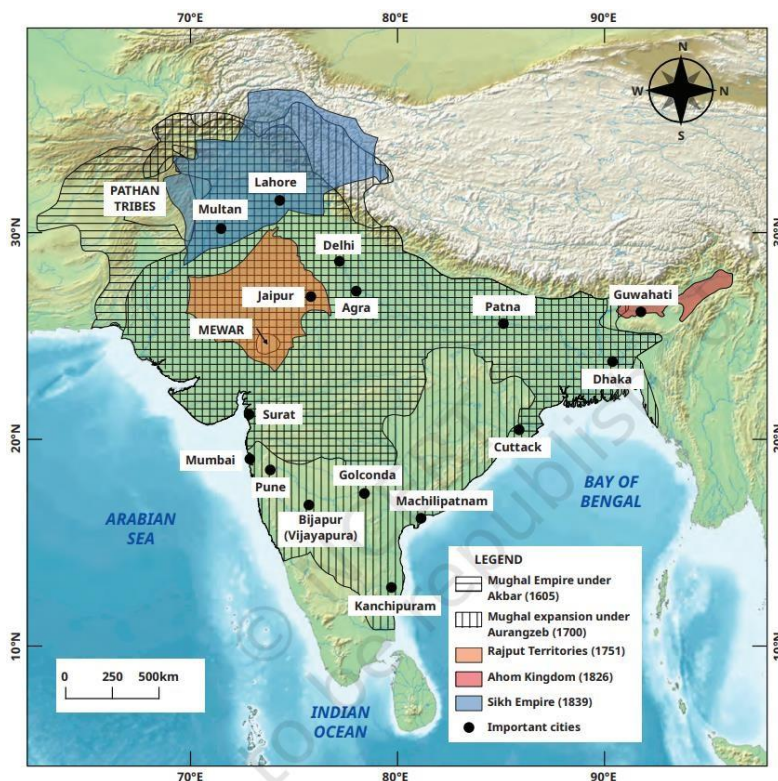
The Mughals

- Delhi Sultanate – weak – **Babur** – Turkic-Mongol ruler – military strategist – thrown out – Samarkand (present – Uzbekistan) – turned sight – India
- Descendent Timur – Babur – defeated Ibrahim Lodi – Panipat – 1526 – later called – 1st battle of Panipat
- Relied heavily – gunpowder, field artillery, matchlock guns – recent intro. – Indian warfare
- This defeat – final end – Delhi Sultanate – laid foundation – **Mughal empire** – Babur assumed control – Delhi Throne
- **Babur and India**
 - Babur – candid autobiography – historical value – *Baburnama*
 - This book – Babur – cultured, intellectually curious – keen appreciation – architecture, poetry, animals, flora
 - BUT also – ruthless, brutal conqueror – slaughter – entire cities – enslave women, children – take pride – towers of skulls – slaughtered people
 - Babur – nostalgic – Central Asia – found India – country – few charms – same time – acknowledge – Hindustan – large country – masses – gold, silver – rainy season – air – remarkably fine – countless artisans, workmen – every sort – Hindustan
 - Perhaps – last reasons – India's wealth – decided – stay, build empire – India – did not return – Central Asia
- Babur's death – 1530 – son **Humayun** – struggled – hold – empire – together

- Taking adv. – Sher Shah Suri – powerful Afghan leader – Sur empire – large parts – north India – introduced – lasting reforms – empire – short-lived – Humayun – reconquered – lost ground
- Before this – **Himu** (Hemu) – skilled military commander, chief minister (wazir) – under last Suri ruler – captured Delhi – ruled briefly – royal name – Hemchandra Vikramaditya
- Some military success – injured – battlefield – 2nd battle of Panipat – confronted by Babur's grandson – **Akbar**
- After capture – Himu – brought to Akbar – beheaded – Akbar – reclaimed Delhi – Mughals

Akbar

- Declared emperor – 13 yr. – father Humayun's accidental death – Akbar – set out – entire Subcontinent – Mughal control – his reign – blend – brutality, tolerance – shaped by – ambition, strategy
- Early conquests – following – many predecessor's ex. – no mercy – fort Chittor (Chittorgarh, Rajasthan) – besieged – 5+ months – determined resistance – Rajput soldiers
- Rajputs inflicted – heavy losses – Mughal army – BUT – fort breached – Rajputs – died fighting – heavy no. – women – *Jauhar*
- Akbar – massacre – 30,000 civilians – women, children – enslaved
- This time – 25 yr. – sent victory msg. – succeeded – occupy – forts, towns – infidels – established Islam – with help – bloodthirsty sword – erased – signs – infidelity – their minds – destroyed temples – entire Hindustan
- Akbar – followed predecessors – monarch – intent on conquest – otherwise – enemies – rise against him
- Empire grew – political strategies – stabilise it – enter – marriage alliance – princesses – neighbouring kingdoms – welcomed – Rajput, regional leaders – his court – abolished *jizya* – promote doctrine – *sulh-i-kul* – peace for all
- Interfaith dialogues – appointment – Hindu officials – high position – other bold reforms – Akbar – expanded, stabilized empire – gain support – Rajput rulers
- Court historian, biographer – Abul Fazl – recorded him stating –
 - Formerly – persecuted men – conformity – my faith – deemed it Islam
 - Grew in knowledge – overwhelmed – shame
 - Not Muslim himself – cannot force others – what stability – expected – proselytes (converted people) – compulsion
- Long reign – 50 yrs. – 1556-1605 (death) – middle period – peaceful – last 15 yrs. – military campaigns – Kashmir, Sindh, Deccan, Afghanistan
- Despite illiterate – Akbar – keen – explore Persian, Indian texts – great interest – classical Indian thought – invited scholars – court
- Established – house of translation – Fatehpur Sikri – major Sanskrit texts – translated – Persian – incl. – Mahabharata, Ramayana, *Bhagavad Gita*, *Panchatantra*



- Akbar's son – **Jahangir** – shared love – art, architecture – with father – expand empire – Deccan
- His son – **Shah Jahan** – several rebellions – remembered – builder – Taj Mahal
- Taj Mahal – even today – great architectural marvel
- This period – peak – immense flowering – art, architecture – included – Humayun's tomb (Delhi) – Red Forts (Delhi, Agra)
- Other classical arts, music – India – flourished – this period – remarkable works – calligraphy, miniature painting

Aurangzeb

- Mentioned earlier – freq. violent successions – Sultanate period – repeated – succession – Shah Jahan – fell ill – 1657
- He wished – throne – **Dara Shikoh** – eldest son – BUT – younger brother – **Aurangzeb** – defeated him – several battles – executed him – presented head – father
- Also removed – other 2 brothers – 1 – arrested, executed – other – sent to exile
- Prevent further challenge – his rule – imprisoned father – Agra Fort – died there
- Crowned himself – emperor – 1658 – named himself – Alamgir – ruled – 49+ yrs.
- Aurangzeb – skilled – military matters – many campaigns – conquer parts – South
- His reign – Mughal empire – greatest expansion – ALSO – significant rebellions – some – next section
- Aurangzeb – last 25 yrs. – fighting continuous wars – Deccan
- Maintain – large armies – these campaigns – deplete – empire's treasury – great strain – administration
- This – considered – key factor – rapid decline – Mughal empire – Aurangzeb's death – 1707
- Aurangzeb – Islam's Sunni sect – deeply religious – austere life – obs. – all rituals, occasions
- Gradually – banned practices – un-Islamic – music, dance – his court
- Also – reimposed – *jizya* tax, pilgrimage tax – both – abolished by Akbar
- Some scholars – argue – Aurangzeb's motives – political – establish, strengthen – empire's dominance – also ex. – grants, assurances – protection – some temples
- Politics – part – decisions – his farmans (firmans) – personal religious motives – also clear
- 1669 – ordered governors – all provinces – demolish – schools, temples – infidels – put down – teachings, religious practices
- Temples – Banaras, Mathura, Somnath, many others – destroyed – also Jain temples, Sikh gurdwaras
- This aspect – Aurangzeb – also visible – persecution – Muslims – other sects – Zoroastrians

Resistance to the Mughals

- Survey – major rebellions – eroded – Mughal power
- Over centuries – peasant communities – rebelled – harsh exploitation
- 1 such case – 17th cent. – **Jat peasantry** (present-day – U.P., Haryana, east Rajasthan) – managed – kill – oppressive officer – Mughal administration
- 1 battle – 20,000 men – confront – Mughal army – fought valiantly – BUT – Jat leader – killed – rebellion suppressed
- Tribal grps. – **Bhils, Gonds, Santhals, Kochs** – fought back – territory annexure – tax imposition
- Some grps. – subdued, integrated – Delhi Sultanate, Mughal empire – other – forested, hilly, remote areas – managed – maintain – some independence
- **Rani Durgavati**
 - Remembered – valiant queen – Garha kingdom – Gond kingdom – Central India
 - All accounts – ruled wisely – kingdom prosperous

- Army – 20,000 soldiers – 1000 elephants – repelled – several invasions
- Akbar's general – attack kingdom – 1564 – outnumbered, outmatched – led, fought – bravely
- Wounded – took – own life – battlefield – avoid capture – only 40 yrs. old
- Sacrifice – symbol – regional pride, resistance – still known – heroic fig. – Indian history

Surge of the Rajputs

- Their location – northwest India – proud traditions – inherited – earlier dynasties – Pratiharas – resisted Arab invasion - Sindh – few cent. earlier
- **Rajputs** – often battle – invading forces – beyond subcontinent
- Rebuilt kingdoms – Khilji's conquest – 2 major clans – emerged – Mewar, Marwar
- Inspirational stories – their heroic deeds – still told – particularly – popular ballads
- Valorous rulers – these clans – met Rana Kumbha – earlier
- **Rana Sanga** – early 16th cent. – unified – Rajput clans – won many battles – defeated by – Babur – battle of Khanwa
- **Maharana Pratap** – inherited – wounded kingdom – predecessors – rejected Mughal suzerainty – face – Rajput resistance
- Confrontation – Haldighati – Aravallis – 1576 – Mughal army – upper hand – BUT – Maharana Pratap – escaped, pursued – **guerilla warfare** – against Mughals – Aravalli hills – harsh conditions – BUT – firm – independence
- Noteworthy – Maharana Pratap – strong support – Bhils – joined as archers – also – contributed – knowledge of terrain
- Their service – earned them – respected place – Mewar's military tradition
- Some Rajput states – aligned – Mughals – diplomacy, marriage alliance – BUT – some – Mewar – did not accept – Mughal dominance
- Aurangzeb's reign – Rajput nobles – rebelled – Durga Das Rathore – Marwar – fought – protect independence – Jodhpur
- Mughal authority – limited – Rajasthan

The Ahoms

- 13th cent. – Ahom ethnic grp. – migrated – Myanmar to Brahmaputra valley – formed – Ahom kingdom
- Both – Sultanate, Mughal periods – Ahom rulers – stiff resistance – attempts – expansion – northeast
- Unique – *paik* sys. – every able-body man – provide service – labour, military duty – exchange – land rights
- Slowed rulers – create – public infrastructure – maintain – large standing force – without army
- Overtime – Ahoms – assimilate – local culture – promote agriculture – encourage faiths – contribute – rich traditions – Assam
- 17th cent. – Aurangzeb – Mughal forces – brief capture – Ahom capital – Garhgaon – Ahoms – used knowledge – terrain – dense forests, hills, rivers – persistent guerrilla attacks – repulse attacks – latter – larger fleet – men, boats
- Notably – Battle of Saraighat – 1671 – Brahmaputra river – Ahom commander – Lachit Borphukan – 10,000 men – defeated – Mughal force – 30,000 soldiers – Ahom – preserve independence

The rise of the Sikhs

- 15th cent. Punjab – **Guru Nanak** – spread msg. – equality, compassion, oneness of God (*Ik Onkar*) – his followers – Sikh
- Sikhism – purely spiritual movement – later Sikh Gurus – respond – intolerance, persecution – Mughal rulers

- Emperor Jahangir – found out – Guru Arjan – supported Jahangir’s rebellious son – tortured **Guru Arjan** – death
- Prompted – Guru Arjan’s son, successor – **Guru Hargobind** – introduce martial trainings – form – Sikh army – several battles – against Mughal forces
- 1675 – grp. – Kashmiri Pandits – approached **Guru Tegh Bahadur** – protection – religious persecution
- Guru decided – stand with them – court martyrdom – arrested – ordered – convert to Islam
- Torture, witness torture – 2 disciples – Guru refused – Aurangzeb’s orders – publicly beheaded – Chandni Chowk, Delhi
- Response – son – **Guru Gobind Singh** – 10th, last Guru – estd. – **Khalsa** – martial brotherhood – committed – justice, equality, defence of faith – frequently clashed – Mughal forces – great cost – life
- Mughal empire – declined – onslaughts – Marathas – several Sikh confederacies – emerged – Punjab region – unified – efforts – **Maharaja Ranjit Singh** – 19th cent.
- Ranjit Singh – military acumen, diplomatic skills, religious tolerance – allowed – establish – strong, centralized Sikh empire – spanned – Northwest – incl. Kashmir
- Mid-19th cent. – empire – resisted – Mughal remnants – later British expansion

Administering India

Administration under Delhi Sultanate

- Delhi Sultanate – political sys. – centred – Sultan – absolute authority – political, military head – duties – contemporary chronicles – defending territories – Islam – possible aggression – collecting fees, taxes – keep in touch – public affairs – condition of people
- Sultan – assisted by – council – ministers – in charge – various departments
- 1 instrument – administration – *iqta* sys. – territories – assigned to nobles (*iqtdars*) collect taxes – Sultan’s treasury – maintain army
- Sys. – network – local administrators – loyal – central authority – BUT – post – not hereditary
- Taxes – levied – trade – every stage – burden – most heavy – peasants – some accounts – report – considerable cruelty – extracting revenue

The Mughal administrative framework

- Aim – greater control, efficiency – Akbar – reorganized administration
- *Diwan* – took care – finances – *Mir Bakhshi* – military matters – *Khan-i-Sanam* – public works, trade, industry, agriculture
- *Sadr* – responsible – justice, religion, education
- Such ministers – assigned – 12 provinces (*subah*) – further subdivided – effective checks, balances – enforced – govt. officials
- Village level – traditional structures – self-governance – undisturbed
- Akbar – *mansabdari* sys.
- Abul Fazl – record – *Ain-i-Akbari* – describe – Akbar’s admin. – *mansabdars* (officers) – expected – maintain – precise no. – elephants, horses, camels, troops – a/c. – *mansab* (rank)
- Made possible – assemble army – short notice – without maintaining – permanent army
- Regular inspections – ensure compliance – paid – assigned land (*jagirs*) – known as *jagirdars*
- Akbar’s growing tolerance – diff. faiths – BUT – non-Muslims – minority – higher echelons – admin.
- Ex. – total percentage – non-Muslims – admin. – less than 1/3rd of total
- Even among Muslims – foreign origin – preferred over – India origin

- Todar Mal – Akbar's finance minister – efficient revenue sys. – detailed surveys – crop yields, prices – setup – crop prices – based on this info.
- Also initiated – systematic survey – land – entire empire – boosted revenue collection – strengthened state

People's Lives

- Shifting political powers – 13th-17th cent. – India – vibrant eco. act. – agrarian foundations, artisanal industries, community, temple-based economies – extensive trade networks
- Building – decentralized economic, social sys. – *shrenis* (guilds), *jatis* (professional communities), credit sys. – subcontinent – wealthiest regions
- Sultanate period – progress – infrastructural works – roads, bridges, canals, irrigation works – considerable expansion – Mughal period
- Coins – several metals, denominations – introduced – currency
- Mughals – diff. sys. – *rupaya* – silver – *dam* – copper
- Agriculture – mainstay – Indian economy – already seen – rulers relied – agrarian revenue – maintain – admin., military – land revenue – 1/5th of produce – some sultans – raised – ½
- Expansion – irrigation sys. – increased production – allow – multiple crops – food – rice, wheat, barley, pulses, sugarcane, spices – non-food – cotton, silk, wool, dye, timber, jute
- Note – agriculture output – vary – region to region – period to period – peasant suffered – several famines – this period – relief – depend on – ruler's benevolence
- Craftspersons – wide range – products – weapons, utensils, ornaments, jewellery
- Ship-building – essential – river, overseas trade – developed – those cent.
- Indian goods – exported – coastal, riverside towns – Calicut, Mangalore, Surat, Masulipatnam, Hooghly
- Imports – much less than – exports – import products – silk, horses, metals, all luxury
- Merchants – Arab, Persia, Central Asia – settled – Indian ports – contribute – trade
- *Hundi* sys. – enabled merchants – transfer funds – political boundaries – without currency – less vulnerable – plunder
- Trade communities – Marwaris – adept – operating across political regimes – parallel sys. – credit, trust – func. independently – official structures
- **Temples as centres of economic activity**
 - Many temple – more than – centres – worship, learning, social interaction, performing arts
 - Also created – ecosystems – bustling markets – ruling classes – donate land, wealth (*dana*) – temple deities – held in trust – temple managers – developed community infrastructure – pilgrim accommodations
 - Temples – provided merchants – credits – funds – internal, maritime trade
- Early periods – prosperity – late 1600s – economic stress
- Peasants – often left – small share – their produce – after taxes, payments – many – lose land – bonded labourers
- Historians suggest – craftspeople, labourers – faced – harsh eco. conditions
- India – still – land of abundance – testified – Arab, European travelers – BUT – wealth – conc. – rulers, courtiers, high officials, merchant class
- Freq. warfare – forced displacement – population
- Level – common people – instances – clashes – sacred sites – desecrated, destroyed – ruler's sanction
- BUT – people – diff. faiths, communities – peacefully – economic dependence – each other

- Most rulers – across India – patronized arts, communities – maintain, revive – traditions – adapted – changing circumstances
- Among – cultural traditions – fair degree – interaction – result – shared heritage
- Through all – India – endured – economically prosperous – BUT – politically unstable
- This period – freq. reshaping – political map – India – serious challenges – BUT – survived
- This tale – hardship – BUT also – resilience – through sword – occasion demanded – BUT also – fresh creation – art, literature, spirituality, timeless values